

THE 5 R's OF CHANGE

Responsibility • Rethink • Reject • Review • Resound

Write down the answer to this “By the end of this year, I want to become someone who_____.

Ask God to show you **one belief, behavior, habit, attitude, relationship pattern, or area of your life** where you need transformation.

“You’re one decision away from a totally different life.” — Mark Batterson

Change sounds exciting when we talk about the **result**.

“I want a better marriage.”
“I want to be healthier.”
“I want to grow spiritually.”
“I want to stop being so negative.”
“I want better relationships.”
“I want to get out of debt.”
“I want to become more disciplined.”

But change becomes uncomfortable when we talk about the **process**.

Because real change usually means breaking habits, changing routines, confronting attitudes, having difficult conversations, setting boundaries, and doing something different from what we have always done.

And all of that challenges three things we naturally crave:

Security. Familiarity. Comfort.

Sometimes we don't stay where we are because we like it.

We stay there because **we know it**.

The familiar can feel safer than the unknown—even when the familiar is unhealthy.

So if I want a different life, something has to change.

And sometimes the first thing that has to change is **ME**.

R1 — RESPONSIBILITY

Take responsibility for yourself and your life.

You have probably heard the word *responsibility* so many times from parents, teachers, bosses, pastors, and authority figures that you may have developed an allergy to it!

But responsibility is actually empowering.

Responsibility says:

“I may not be able to control everything that happens to me, but I can take responsibility for what I do next.”

There are things that happened to you that you didn't choose.

But there comes a point when you have to decide what you're going to do with what happened.

You cannot change what someone else did.

You cannot control another person's attitude.

You cannot control your childhood.

You cannot control your boss.

You cannot control your spouse.

You cannot control what somebody posts about you.

But you CAN control **your response**.

Think about a treadmill.

You can run like crazy on a treadmill.

You can sweat.

You can breathe hard.

You can exhaust yourself.

But when you get off, you're standing in exactly the same geographical location where you started.

That's what life can feel like when we refuse responsibility.

We expend enormous amounts of emotional energy blaming:

“My husband...”

“My parents...”

“My boss...”

“My childhood...”

“My friends...”

“The devil...”

“If they hadn't...”

“If she would...”

“If he would just...”

But blaming someone else gives them control over whether your life ever changes.

Responsibility takes the steering wheel back.

Responsibility Is Practical

Responsibility means:

If the grass needs mowing—**mow it.**

If the car needs oil—**change it.**

If you spent the money—**own it.**

If you said it—**own it.**

If you hurt someone—**apologize.**

If you're always late—**leave earlier.**

If your phone keeps distracting you—**put it down.**

If what you're watching is affecting your spirit—**turn it off.**

If a relationship keeps pulling you backward—**set a boundary.**

Quit making “I didn't know” the excuse for things you are now responsible to learn.

You are responsible for YOU.

Your spirit.

Your soul.

Your body.

Your words.

Your choices.

Your habits.

Your relationships.

Your growth.

Guard Your Relationships

You are also responsible for managing who has influence in your life.

“Bad company corrupts good character.” — 1 Corinthians 15:33

Not everybody deserves the same level of access to you.

Some people encourage who you're becoming.

Others constantly invite you back into who you used to be.

Ask yourself:

“Who am I becoming when I'm around this person?”

That question can tell you a lot about a relationship.

Jesus taught that what we treasure eventually reveals where our heart is.

What you continually allow **inside** eventually begins showing up **outside**.

ACTIVATION — THE RESPONSIBILITY CIRCLE

Draw two circles.

In one write:

THINGS I CANNOT CONTROL

Put things like:

Other people's opinions
What happened yesterday
Someone else's attitude
What people say about me
Other people's decisions

In the second write:

THINGS I CAN CONTROL

My attitude
My words
My boundaries
My habits
My response
My effort
My obedience
My relationships
What I watch
What I listen to
What I do next

Then ask:

“Where have I been spending energy trying to control something that isn't mine?”

And:

“What responsibility have I been avoiding?”

Finally ask yourself:

Do I want to still be dealing with this same issue one year from now?

Five years from now?

Ten years from now?

If the answer is no, something has to change.

R2 — RETHINK

Change the way you think.

The Greek word often connected with repentance is **metanoia**.

It carries the idea of a **change of mind**—a fundamental reorientation in thinking that results in a changed direction.

We sometimes think repentance simply means:

“I feel bad about what I did.”

But biblical repentance isn't merely feeling bad.

It's thinking differently so that eventually you **live differently**.

Before your behavior changes, your thinking usually has to change.

Consider a GPS.

You are driving somewhere and suddenly hear:

“Rerouting.”

The GPS isn't condemning you.

It's simply telling you:

“The road you're currently taking isn't going to get you where you said you wanted to go.”

Sometimes God has to reroute our thinking.

You might have spent years thinking:

“I'll always be this way.”

“I can't trust anybody.”

“I'm not smart enough.”

“Everybody leaves me.”

“I could never do that.”

“That's just how my family is.”

“I've always had a temper.”

“I'm just a negative person.”

But then the Word of God confronts your old thinking.

And suddenly God says:

RETHINK THAT.

Sometimes Rethinking Means Changing Your Environment

If you want to grow, find people who are growing.

Find people with stronger character.

Find people who manage money better.

Find people with healthy marriages.

Find people who love God's Word.

Find people who challenge you.

Find people who aren't impressed with your excuses.

You don't always need people who make you comfortable.

Sometimes you need people who make you **hungry to grow**.

And sometimes growth means being brave enough to release relationships that continually pull you backward.

ACTIVATION — RETHINK IT

Write down one belief you have carried about yourself.

For example:

OLD THOUGHT:

“I never finish anything.”

Now ask:

Is that actually true?

Then ask:

What does God's Word say?

Create a replacement thought:

NEW THOUGHT:

“With God's help, I can become disciplined and finish what I start.”

Every time the old thought appears, practice replacing it.

Because you cannot consistently live beyond the way you consistently think.

R3 — REJECT

Reject your old ways.

Rethinking teaches you the new way.

Rejecting keeps you from returning to the old way.

And this may be the hardest part.

Because **old habits die hard**.

There is something strangely comforting about the familiar.

When life gets stressful, we naturally reach for what we've always done.

The old attitude.

The old relationship.

The old coping mechanism.

The old thought pattern.

The old addiction.

The old excuse.

The old response.

It's like putting on your favorite old sweatshirt.

It may be worn out.

It may have holes.

It may not even fit anymore.

But it feels familiar.

That's how old thinking works.

You have to learn to say:

“That's how I USED to think.”

“That's how I USED to respond.”

That's how I used to react

“That's what I USED to do.”

“But I'm not going back there.”

Your Thoughts Matter

You are continually being shaped by what you think.

And your thought life is greatly influenced by:

The words you hear.

And:

The words you speak.

If change is going to become reality, you must learn to reject thoughts that oppose God's truth.

Romans 12 teaches us not to allow the world to mold us into its image, but to be **transformed from the inside out by the renewing of our minds.**

You cannot prevent every thought from knocking on the door.

But you don't have to invite every thought inside and give it dinner.

Some thoughts need to be answered:

“NO. I don't think that anymore.”

Example:

Thought:

“Nobody cares about me.”

Stop.

Ask:

“Is that truth—or is that emotion talking?”

Then replace it with truth.

Thought:

“I’m going to fail.”

Stop.

Ask:

“What evidence do I actually have for that?”

Then replace fear with God’s Word.

ACTIVATION — CATCH IT, CHECK IT, CHANGE IT

For the next seven days, when you recognize a negative thought:

1. CATCH IT.

What am I thinking?

2. CHECK IT.

Is this true? Is this biblical? Is this helpful?

3. CHANGE IT.

What truth should replace it?

Choose **one Scripture** connected to the area where you’re changing.

Write it down.

Put it on your mirror.

Put it in your phone.

Say it every morning.

Meditate on it until God’s truth becomes louder than your old thinking.

R4 — REVIEW

Review your new way of thinking and acting.

Change needs evaluation.

You don't just make a decision and never examine it again.

Ask:

“Is this working?”

“Am I actually changing?”

“What keeps triggering the old behavior?”

“Where am I improving?”

“Where do I need another adjustment?”

You're not stuck where you are.

God has given you the ability to grow.

If you're constantly critical—practice encouragement.

If you're always complaining—practice gratitude.

If you're always late—practice leaving early.

If you're constantly interrupting—practice listening.

If you spend impulsively—practice waiting 24 hours before buying.

If you automatically assume the worst—practice asking questions before drawing conclusions.

Practice your new behavior.

We practiced our old behavior until it became automatic.

Now we practice something new until **it becomes our new normal.**

CHANGE YOUR QUESTIONS

One of the easiest ways to review your thinking is to listen to the questions you're asking yourself.

JUDGER QUESTIONS

“What is wrong with me?”

“Why doesn't anything ever work?”

“Why is everyone so clueless?”

“Whose fault is this?”

“How can I prove I'm right?”

“Why bother?”

Notice what those questions produce:

Pessimism.

Negativity.

Stress.

Criticism.

Defensiveness.

Inflexibility.

Win/lose relationships.

But change the questions and you can begin changing your perspective.

LEARNER QUESTIONS

“What do I want?”

“What is my goal?”

“What is working?”

“What can I learn?”

“What am I assuming?”

“What are the actual facts?”

“What am I missing?”

“What choices do I have?”

“What action makes the most sense?”

“What is possible?”

These questions produce:

Hope.

Possibility.

Curiosity.

Flexibility.

Responsiveness.

Collaboration.

Connection.

REAL-LIFE EXAMPLE

Someone doesn't answer your text.

Judger:

“They're ignoring me. They don't care about me.”

Learner:

“What facts do I actually have?”

Fact:

They haven't answered my text.

That's all you actually know!

Maybe they're working.

Maybe they're driving.

Maybe their phone died.

Maybe they're dealing with something.

Your assumptions can create an emotional reaction to something that hasn't even happened.

PSALM 1

Psalm 1 gives us a beautiful picture of someone who carefully manages their influences and continually meditates on God's Word.

That person becomes like:

A tree planted by streams of water.

Stable.

Rooted.

Fruitful.

Resilient.

Healthy.

The Message paraphrase vividly describes avoiding the wrong road and instead delighting in God's Word until your life becomes like a flourishing tree.

Why?

Because **what feeds your roots eventually appears in your fruit.**

ACTIVATION — WEEKLY REVIEW

Once a week ask yourself:

What went well this week?

Where did I fall back into an old pattern?

What triggered it?

What did I learn?

What will I do differently next time?

Don't turn the review into condemnation.

Turn it into **information.**

You aren't reviewing yourself to beat yourself up.

You're reviewing yourself so you can **grow.**

And remember:

Making a big life change can be scary—but living with regret can be scarier.

You have to want change more than you fear it.

R5 — RESOUND

Let the Word of God inside you RESOUND out loud.

Romans 10:17 teaches:

“Faith comes by hearing, and hearing by the word of God.”

There comes a point when truth can't just be something you read.

You need to **hear yourself saying it.**

Your old thoughts have had a microphone long enough.

Give God's Word the microphone.

Speak truth.

Declare truth.

Pray truth.

Worship with truth.

Let truth **RESOUND.**

PAUL'S MIND DIET

Philippians 4:8 gives us a filter for what we allow our minds to continually consume.

Think of it like a nutritional label for your thoughts.

Before allowing something to live in your mind, ask:

Should I be feeding on this?

TRUE THINGS

Is this actually true?

Or am I imagining something?

Assuming something?

Exaggerating something?

Replaying a lie?

Our minds need to be grounded in **truth and Scripture**.

HONORABLE THINGS

Does this thought honor God?

Does it honor others?

Does it honor who God is forming me to become?

Practice thinking honorably toward your spouse, children, parents, pastors, leaders, coworkers, and employers.

RIGHTEOUS THINGS

Does this thought reflect God's righteousness, justice, character, and Kingdom?

PURE THINGS

Don't continually feed your mind morally polluted material and then wonder why your thought life feels polluted.

Guard what enters through your eyes and ears.

LOVELY THINGS

Feed your mind things that cultivate beauty, peace, gratitude, healthy relationships, and appreciation for God's goodness.

ADMIRABLE THINGS

Who inspires you?

What kind of character makes you say:

“I want to become more like that”?

Be careful what you admire because:

We naturally move toward what we continually admire.

EXCELLENT THINGS

Give your mind a quality diet.

Read things that stretch you.

Spend time around people who challenge you.

Put yourself in environments that call you higher.

Don't continually feed your mind mediocrity while asking God for excellence.

PRAISEWORTHY THINGS

One powerful way to interrupt dark thinking is gratitude.

When your mind starts spiraling toward everything wrong, intentionally identify **one thing that is right**.

Then say it out loud:

“God, thank You for...”

It can be something incredibly simple.

“Thank You for my family.”

“Thank You for this meal.”

“Thank You that I woke up today.”

“Thank You for another opportunity.”

“Thank You that You haven't given up on me.”

Gratitude interrupts the cycle.

ACTIVATION — THE PHILIPPIANS 4:8 MIND AUDIT

Think about what you've consumed during the last seven days:

What have you watched?

What have you listened to?

Who have you talked to?

What conversations have you repeatedly had?

What social media have you consumed?

What thoughts have you rehearsed?

Now ask:

Is my current mental diet producing the person I want to become?

Choose one thing to **REMOVE** this week.

Choose one thing to **ADD**.

Maybe:

Less social media → more Scripture.

Less gossip → more encouraging conversations.

Less complaining → more gratitude.

Less negative news → more worship.

Less time with draining influences → more time with growing people.

PUTTING THE 5 R's TOGETHER

Imagine someone says:

“I want to stop being so negative.”

Here's what change looks like.

RESPONSIBILITY

“I recognize that I'm responsible for the words coming out of my mouth.”

RETHINK

“I begin learning what God's Word says about gratitude, hope, faith, and my words.”

REJECT

When the old negative thought appears:

“No. I'm not going to feed that thought anymore.”

REVIEW

At the end of the day:

“How did I do today? When did negativity show up? What triggered it?”

RESOUND

Instead of speaking negativity:

“God is faithful.”

“I have something to be thankful for.”

“God is working in my life.”

“Today is a gift.”

That is how change begins becoming a lifestyle.

FINAL ACTIVATION — WHO HAVE I YET TO BECOME?

Ask yourself:

“What belief or behavior do I want transformed by the end of this year?”

Don't write ten things.

Write **ONE**.

Then walk that one thing through the 5 R's.

1. RESPONSIBILITY

What do **I** need to own?

2. RETHINK

What do I need to start believing differently?

3. REJECT

What old thought, behavior, habit, excuse, or relationship pattern must I stop returning to?

4. REVIEW

How will I know I'm actually changing?

5. RESOUND

What Scripture or declaration will I begin speaking over this area?

Write your answers down.

Then complete this sentence:

“By the end of this year, I want to become someone who _____.”

And beneath it write:

“I'm on the hunt for who I've yet to become.”

Because change isn't simply about becoming a better version of your old self.

It's about allowing God to transform you into someone you've **never been before**.

You are one decision away from beginning a totally different direction.

Take responsibility.

Rethink.

Reject.

Review.

Resound.

And then do it again tomorrow.